HMGT 311 · LUXURY BRAND MANAGEMENT

Strategic Brand Management: The Ritz-Carlton

Assignment 3 · Brand Attributes, Recommendations & the 4-Step Process · Summary Sheet · Fall 2026

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1 Brand Attributes of The Ritz-Carlton

"We are Ladies and Gentlemen serving Ladies and Gentlemen." More than 100 hotels worldwide, part of Marriott International; in Saudi Arabia: The Ritz-Carlton, Riyadh and The Ritz-Carlton, Jeddah.

Tangible (functional)

Iconic locations & palace-style buildings · spacious rooms, fine dining, spas, club lounges, ballrooms · the **Gold Standards** (Credo, Motto, Three Steps of Service) · lion-and-crown logo, blue & gold identity.

Intangible (emotional)

Personalized, anticipatory service · staff empowered to spend up to **US$2,000** per guest issue · heritage of César Ritz ("ritzy") · trust: Baldrige Award 1992 & 1999 · status, discretion, elegance.

Strong attributes & personality · Clear niche · High loyalty · Price premium · Valuable asset

2 Recommendations to Make the Brand Stronger

01 — Local authenticity
Saudi heritage in design, cuisine, art & storytelling.

02 — Quiet luxury & real sustainability
Clear, measurable green goals for Millennials & Gen Z.

03 — Digital + human touch
Seamless app & data personalization, warm personal service.

04 — Protect consistency
Gold Standards in every extension: residences, yachts, Reserve.

05 — Invest in people
Training, careers & Saudi talent aligned with Vision 2030.

06 — Emotional loyalty & tracking
Experience-based rewards; brand audits, reviews & NPS.

3 Applying the Strategic Brand Management Process (Keller, 2013)

- **Step 1 · Positioning & values:** target high-income business/leisure, VIP & event guests · frame: Four Seasons, St. Regis, Mandarin Oriental · **POP:** luxury rooms, locations, dining · **POD:** legendary personalized service & heritage · mantra: "legendary, genuine, personalized care".
- **Step 2 · Marketing programs:** memorable, protectable brand elements · product (renovations, signature spa) · premium value-based pricing · direct & Marriott Bonvoy channels · IMC & word of mouth · secondary associations: Marriott, César Ritz, Riyadh.
- **Step 3 · Measuring performance:** brand audit (inventory + exploratory) · sources: awareness, image, free associations · outcomes: comparative & holistic methods · tracking: satisfaction, reviews, repeat stays, RevPAR premium.
- **Step 4 · Growing & sustaining:** brand architecture in Marriott's luxury portfolio · sub-brands: Reserve, Residences, Yacht Collection · reinforce consistency · revitalize via wellness, weddings, new Saudi destinations.

Key takeaway: The Ritz-Carlton's strength comes from a clear promise of legendary, personalized service, protected by the Gold Standards and managed through all four steps of strategic brand management. Local authenticity, real sustainability and investment in people will keep it strong in the fast-growing Saudi luxury market.

Key sources: Aaker (1991) · Chevalier & Mazzalovo (2012) · Kapferer & Bastien (2012) · Keller (2013) · Kotler & Keller (2016) · Michelli (2008) · The Ritz-Carlton Hotel Company (Gold Standards) · UPM HMGT 311 Ch. 3–4 slides